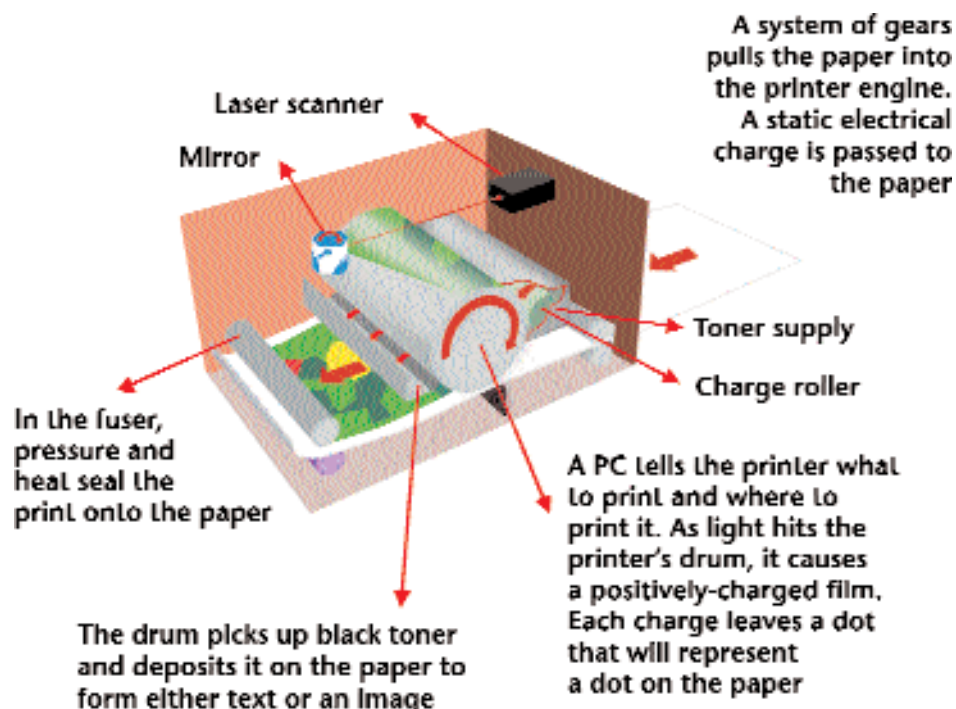


Under the bonnet of a Laser Printer



Jargon Buster

Align: To line up typeset or other graphic material as specified, using a base or vertical line as the reference point.

Blanket cylinder: The cylinder which the inked litho plate transfers the image to the paper. The cylinder is covered with a rubber sheet which prevents wear to the litho plate coming into contact with the paper.

Bleed: The region of the page that is beyond the marked area within which printing usually occurs.

Buffer: Memory within the printer that stores data from the computer until it can be printed. Buffers vary in size, with the average for laser printers being around 8 MB. Greater the buffer, the better the handling of large print jobs.

CMYK: Short for Cyan, Magenta, Yellow and Black. These are the colours used in the industry-standard 'four colour process printing'. By combining these colours, a printer is able to print all possible colours. Most full-colour media that you see are created by this method (magazines, brochures, retail packaging, etc).

Coated: Printing papers which after making have had a surface coating with clay etc., to give a smoother, more even finish with greater opacity.

Cropping: The elimination of parts of a photograph or other original that are not required to be printed. Cropping allows the remaining parts of the image to be enlarged to fill the space.

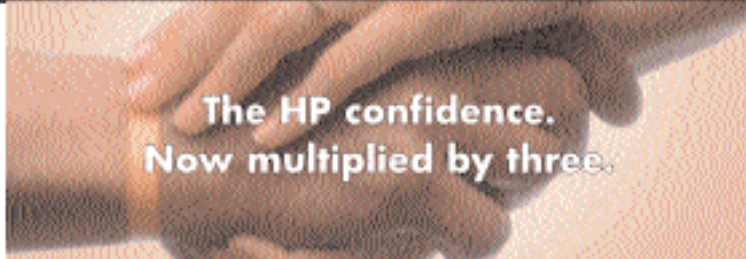
Colour Balance: This term refers to the correct combination of Cyan, Magenta and Yellow required to exactly reproduce the colours of the original scene or object

Colour separations: The division of a multicolored original or line copy into the basic (or primary) process colors of yellow, magenta, cyan and black. These should not be confused with the optical primaries; Red, Green and Blue.

DPI: Short for Dots Per Inch, this is a measure of the vertical resolution of the printer. Higher dpi values (1200 and above) produce sharper printouts, while lower dpi values (300 and below) produce images that have noticeable dots in them.



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